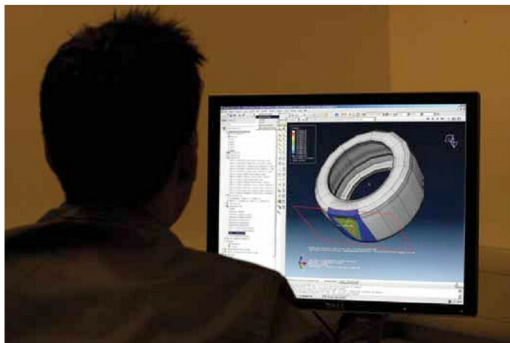


# Product Design is More Than Just Engineering

While product design is an advanced branch of engineering, it is also a creative process. So engineers who lack creativity and out-of-the-box thinking are not suited for this profession



DIKSHA P GUPTA

**R**ight from the smartphone in your hand to the electric kettle in your kitchen, every single gadget that you use is a perfect combination of technological innovation and aesthetics. Designers of smartphones, tablets and other electronics products are expected to combine these two attributes in their products.

Product design and computer-aided design (CAD) engineering is a field that not only requires great technological know-how but also understanding of the market demands and aesthetic sense to develop something extraordinary. This surely is a difficult combination for one person to acquire. But if you can do

that, product design and CAD is the domain for you.

Commenting on the growth of product design and CAD in the country, Rajiv Kapur, managing director, Broadcom India, says, "The design and manufacturing level in India is very low, especially if you compare it with consumption level of electronics. There are two kinds of business models around product design activity: One is the outsourcing business model where some companies in India design for their clients within or outside the country, while the other model is designing in India for the domestic market. There are some good companies like Wipro working in the outsourcing space, which design products based on their clients' requirements. Product

design at chip level is happening on a significant level in companies like ours. About 12 per cent of our global headcount is in India, which is the largest we have outside the US. If you talk about the quality of work, the first 28-nanometre chip was made out of India. This gives a clear idea of what kind of design is happening in the Indian geography."

Milind Shah, founder and chief executive officer, WishTel, adds, "With the emerging smartphone, tablet and laptop market, the scope of product design engineers increases manifold. The Indian govern-

ment is supporting indigenous manufacturing, which is working in favour of the industry as well as aspirants looking to make a career in this segment."

Though the current global economic pressures are likely to hit the electronics market, some companies still have a positive outlook.

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